

mobile so you won't miss it even while travelling! With the recent buzz about mobile television in India as well as in other countries, this cannot now be called a thing of the future. It's happening now. Mobile service providers in Italy such as Hutch 3G are already providing these services.

Mobile television will work in the same way as Internet television, unlike the relayed television series we have via cable in our homes. Users will download a mobisode—an episode that has been digitised and optimised to be played on a mobile device. Broadcast technology aimed at mobile devices such as Digital Video Broadcast—handheld (DVB-h) are being developed to handle and play content that is of a quality comparable to television or the movies. As of now, movies on the mobile phone are played in the 3GP format, which is of very poor quality.



News relays often first show up on mobile phones

Innovations in the way in which content can be played are also being experimented with. Methods such as 'Pause and Resume' are being employed by mobile TV providers. This allows a user to pause whatever he is playing and resume it at a later time. This is essential, as a mobile phone is used for a number of other tasks—such as communicating with people!

India, too, has mobile TV being developed by networks such as Zee in collaboration with technology companies such as IBM. The mobisodes that will be launched by Zee will be shorter versions of their episodes. With almost 50,000 hours of content being developed for mobile phones, cell phone users in India can await their daily soap on their mobiles. Though companies aren't developing original content for mobile phones, it's only a matter of time before we see serials and movies made just for the mobile market.